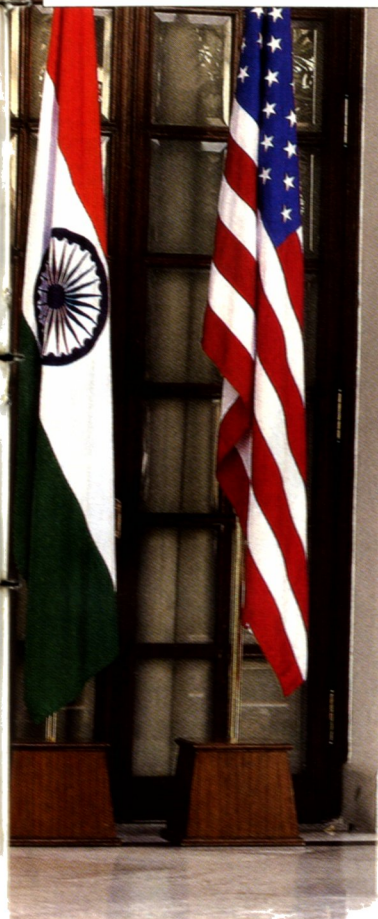




AMAR
SINGH

54, Politician (new)

6

Man in the Middle

Because his support to the government makes it compliant to his demands and the moment he criticised the then finance minister P. Chidambaram for inflation and Petroleum Minister Murli Deora for his 'anti-people' (read anti-Anil Ambani) policies, the media assumed there would be a reshuffle.

Because when the Congress dithered over seat sharing in Uttar Pradesh, he worked out a political realignment with Sharad Pawar over dinner that brought the Congress to the negotiating table.

exchange programme Substituted Prakash Karat for the Gandhis as his new best friends. Says he sees "a ray of hope" in Sonia and Rahul.

the rethink "I have already said that 1999 was a mistake," he says, explaining Samajwadi Party's decision not to support a Congress government at the Centre then.

and finally Has stopped wearing his 10-carat diamond ring because "people said I was wearing it for my Venus angle but the real reason is that my wife gave it to me".

Heavy Metal

Because in a year when the economy is in a state of shock, the group is set to double its revenues from last year and with new businesses, expansion in steel as also the refinery going on-stream, their revenues will touch a trillion rupees by 2011.

Because while other companies are talking about shelving plans, the brothers are investing over Rs 15,000 crore in steel alone, taking their production capacity to 14 metric tonnes per annum, and pledging over half-a-billion dollars to telecom operations in Africa.

Because their businesses span sectors, from 1,500 gas stations through which they will retail petroleum products across India to Aegis, their BPO operations with 35,000 employees.

SHASHIKANT
& RAVI RUIA

65 and 59, Industrialists 12

7



Ravi (left) and
Shashikant

recession mantra Keep your head down, believe in yourself and your people during tough times.

little known fact With 10,000 employees in the US, Essar Group is the largest Indian employer there.

smart strategy With a majority of group companies privately-held, the Ruiaes are insulated from the vagaries of the stock market.